the only heaven i'll be sent to is when i'm alone with you

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/25787383.

Rating:
Explicit

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Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Character:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra)

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Smut, Sexual Fantasy, Masturbation, Guilt, Kink Discovery, Top Adora (She-Ra), basically just adora figuring out its okay to have desires, and still not thinking she can ACT on them but she'll get there, Light Bondage, Service Top Adora and like Power Bottom Catra

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English

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Part 6 of Outside of the War - She-ra canon stories, Part 1 of desires - miniseries

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by n7punk

Summary

Even from opposite sides of the battle line, Adora thinks of Catra — thinks of her in ways she knows she should not. Adora imagines Catra in scenarios that make her gut clench. It is sometimes with excitement, and sometimes with worry. (Or, Adora fantasizing about Catra throughout the years of the war & figuring out what desires are).

Notes

Welcome to an entire fic about Adora being a vers service top and dealing with navigating, discovering, & understanding desires/kinks with like, no guidance and a lot of shame. Title is from Take Me To Church by Hozier because I'm a Big Gay . I basically just listened to it on repeat while writing this. CONTENT WARNING: This starts off with one underage masturbation scene, about 16yo, and then moves on to over the course of the show at 18-20. I'm not comfortable with underage, but this one was important to the narrative. This also deals with internalized shame/guilt over thinking about a friend while getting off and specific desires, which is not internalized homophobia but might still trigger those sensitive to it. Mentions of light d/s play, bondage, and light masochism/clawplay I guess?

See the end of the work for more notes

Adora cannot help straining forward to crane her neck up, peeking her head out from her hiding spot to confirm she is alone one last time before she settles back in the cramped corner. She finally lets her hand drift down, stroking experimentally against herself through her clothes.

She knows what she is doing, in theory. The sex ed the Horde offered them was brief and to the point, designed to prevent the spread of disease and unwanted pregnancy when the inevitable took place and nothing more. Sex was to take place in dark corners, alone or with a trusted confidant, and not discussed in the light of day. It was a quietly-accepted way to blow off steam in a high-stakes environment. Not actively illegal like real relationships were, but not something to be openly discussed.

That did not mean there was not still talk.

Catra had climbed into her bunk late the night before and whispered to her, "I figured it out." A devious smile had spread on her face. Adora, distracted by the downright contentment and mischievousness on her friend's face, took a moment to realize she was *purring*, a low rumble that ran through the bunk and into her own chest. A sound she had not heard in months now. Catra was always forced to bury her more unique tendencies, and this was one she had been trying to stamp out since she was a kitten.

"What did you figure out?" Adora had asked, voice low and breathless. From anticipation, she told herself, not the mere sight of her friend like this.

By the time Catra had finished telling her, she was far more breathless.

Catra had given her instructions, from the advice *she* had overheard from another cadet and what she had then figured out on her own. What she did, how she got there – a quiet spot where no one would catch her while she took care of herself. Adora had been flustered

and blushing, well aware her friend could see her in the low light of after-hours.

She still took her up on it. She is still here, in the spot Catra recommended, hand finally slipping within her waistband to *take care of things*.

"It felt *amazing*. Better than an adrenaline rush. You have to try it," Catra told her, voice a giddy whisper. Even in the low light, Adora could tell she was blushing. She had not stopped purring, either.

And she understands, now, as she maps out the shape of her own skin and explores, what Catra had been talking about. Why she had wanted to share this with her. She moves clumsily, but whenever a movement is *right* it sends a spark of excitement jolting through her. She tries to remember Catra's advice, tracing the movements she had suggested against herself.

The problem is that puts her mind down the course of thinking about Catra, like this, in this spot, merely a day before. Adora feels her face heat, but her hand does not cease its movements, almost like it cannot anymore.

Catra had curled up here, for at least an hour she said, just trying and experimenting. Adora is more than aware of what her friend's naked body looks like, a lifetime of sharing a bunk and communal showers making it all too easy to conjure up the image of her here, in the same spot, touching herself like this.

Adora feels her body twitch on nothing. She should not be thinking about this, not here, not now. She should not think about Catra like that *at all*, but especially not when she is-

Despite how she knows she should stop, she can't. Her mind is wandering down familiar paths, the heat she has long felt looking at her friend taking over after so long suppressing it. She has grown used to turning away as Catra changes, to keeping her gaze fixed steadfastly forward as they shower beside each other, never

acknowledging the flush she feels when she sees her friend. Now, in the moment of giving in, she cannot push the images from her mind.

Catra is laid out, in the spot where she is now, touching herself – in her mind, at least. Only she is not touching herself, *Adora* is, kneeling over her and trailing hands over her skin and short fur. She runs her hands along Catra's chest - her breasts have haunted Adora ever since puberty. Catra *insists* she does not need to wear a bra, leaving her exposed and *taunting* Adora even when she turns away from her as they change. In her fantasy , Catra is gasping at her touch, arching into the contact to press her chest into Adora's hands. Adora feels her hips roll down into the heat of her own hand at the thought. She imagines Catra doing the same, Adora's hands trailing down on her body to touch her, feel her rolling down onto her hand, gazing up at her-

The fantasy comes screeching to a halt as Adora tears her hand away from herself. Catra would not want that – would not want her , not like this, but more so – she would not want Adora above her . Catra is a lot of things, but she is never one to take it lying down, no matter what *it* is. She would not want Adora, she would not want Adora to be thinking of her this way, and she certainly would not want Adora above her, touching her like that.

The heat is still sparking and flaring uselessly between her legs, but the bitter taste of guilt is almost choking her now. Adora hastily fixes her clothes, taking a moment to smooth down her jacket, before she stands and finds her way to the nearest bathroom to clean herself off. She has been pushing down this building feeling for years – she can keep doing it now.

When Catra asks her about it that night, she honestly says she gets it. She had felt the burning ecstasy she had described, for a while. She does not tell her she could not fully get there – she does not need to tell her why.

She certainly does not need to indulge in this again.

--

The sea gate is repaired, Adora's skin unbroken now she has reverted from She-ra, but her non-existent wounds still ache and her heart still feels shattered.

She should not be doing this, not now and not ever, but the frustration and heartbreak, the adrenaline and the thrill of being near Catra again – it is too much for her fragile willpower . Catra would hate her for it – but she already hates her for leaving, doesnt she?

When she lays down in the bed she has only had a few weeks, has hardly done this in at all, she does not even try to fight it as her mind conjures up images of Catra. She touches herself as a scene begins to solidify in her mind.

Catra is above her, this time. That makes her bite down on the shame that wants to well up upon imagining her friend like this. She straddles across Adora's hips, face flushed and hair in disarray as she grinds down into her touch. With her free hand, Adora sweeps along Catra's body, squeezing and feeling the shift of lithe muscles beneath her skin. Catra throws her head back, openly moaning as she grinds into Adora's touch, walls clenching down on her.

The few times Adora has tried this since her disastrous first attempt, it has taken her ages to get there. It has been a struggle, keeping her mind carefully blank and forcing herself to think only of the movements of her own hands, only the way her touch feels, and nothing else. This time, as she lets her mind wander to thoughts of Catra, it is over embarrassingly quickly .

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That fucking *suit*. Adora has never seen Catra in anything but a Horde uniform or totally naked. She *used* to think the latter was her favourite option, until Catra strolled into the ice palace and stopped her heart in more ways than one. She had damn-near lost her mind when she saw Catra there, suit notwithstanding, but it did not *help*.

She wonders, as she trails her hand over herself, if Catra knew. If she knows now how Adora thinks about her, feels about her, and she was purposefully trying to distract her with it. Punish her for it, maybe. She knows she has given nothing away – not anything *new*, anyway – but the fear is still there. It is not enough to stop the movements of her hand.

She had managed to bury her desires under worry for her friends, for a while. Now Glimmer and Bow are back, now Glimmer's glitching seems to be healed, now the battle is over and Bright Moon is safe – now that Adora has a moment of peace to herself, she cannot hold back her thoughts any longer.

In her mind, they are back in the ice palace. Adora is in her dress, and Catra is in *that*. She has Catra against one of the crystalline walls in some private and deserted hallway, much like the hidden corner they had used – separately – in the Fright Zone.

The first time she thought about this, she had almost felt sick at the thought of Catra under her, but she knows more now. Adora has started to read some of the books available in Bright Moon's library. Though none of them have necessarily been about *this*, Bow had insisted she read a book on forming healthy relationships. Something he was sure the Horde had never covered with her – he was right. There had been some discussion, of this side of things. Of romance, of preferences and how to discuss desires and set boundaries. She understands, now, why she wants Catra this way.

She has thought about it, since discovering things like *safe words* – topics introduced that merit further research on their own - and she

thinks Catra would like to be under her, just as much as above her. As long as Catra can still take control – that is what she would need, probably, to feel safe and enjoy herself. To make it as good for her as it is for Adora. So in her mind, she has Catra against the wall. Adora is too in-charge for her liking, so Catra's claws dig into her shoulders to remind her who she is dealing with. Adora twitches down hard into her own touch at the thought and she files the reaction away in the *worry about later* folder.

The suit is still on, pants undone and not even pushed down. Adora has her hand inside the fly, hand working sightlessly as she presses kisses along Catra's neck. Catra sighs into her touch, shifting restlessly, but she relaxes against the frozen wall and lets Adora take care of her.

It was over before it started, really. Adora's orgasm, definitely, but their relationship, too.

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Light hope is – just trying to help her, Adora reasons. She is still *frustrated*. All day fighting Catra, but nowhere near her *heat*. Another simulation, meant to prove a point. Well, she proved it. It has not changed Adora's mind – her heart.

Further research had turned out to be simple. The name of a few topics to look into from the first book, a quick trip out, and Adora had a small stack of books hidden within her vanity. She learned words, descriptions, *reasons* for why her thoughts were like this.

Knowing it is *normal* makes it harder for her to not indulge. She has given up on not thinking about Catra on the rare occasions when she lets herself have some time alone – it would not matter anyway, Catra is in her dreams now, too. She has been for a long time, but

the hazy golden scenes had slipped through her fingers as soon as she awoke, at first. As time has gone on – as they have been apart for longer and longer – the dreams have solidified.

The dreams, at least, are not fantasies. They are one *specific* fantasy: lying in bed with Catra, naked, just the two of them. They hold each other, kiss each other – sometimes they touch each other , too, but that is not the point. The point is the touch of a loved one. Adora swallows bitterly at the phrasing. That is not something she can have with Catra, not something she can have with *anyone*, if she is honest about her role in things. It is easier to focus on her fantasies than address the tangled mess in her heart, constantly threatening to make itself known.

It is almost in rebellion - against Light Hope, against Catra, against her *purpose* keeping her from the one thing she wants - that she lays down in her bed that night, woods still half-frozen over , and thinks of Catra – real Catra – pinned beneath her like she had been in the simulation, Adora straddled over her hips.

She-ra straddled over her hips.

Adora tells herself she is not in control here – she just wants to *take care* of Catra and know she is the one making her feel good. The only one who makes her feel that way – the only one who *has* her. Even kneeling over her, even *fucking* her, she knows Catra *has* her in a very real way. Adora just wants to have her back.

Despite what she tells herself, she still feels her walls clench almost painfully at how *small* Catra is beneath her, like this. At how easy it is to pin her wrists above her head in one hand, the other exploring her body, muscles taunt from stretching her arms above her. In her mind, Catra watches her with bright eyes, patient and curious what Adora has planned for her. More than happy to lay back and let her take care of her.

She has Catra beneath her, *pinned*, and it feels good. Catra arches into the touch, revels in it as Adora's free hand thrusts into her, now.

t feels good, makes something deep within her stir that she has long tried to push down, to hold Catra down and have her take it happily. t also feels bad, guilt gripping at the corners of her mind, but –safe words exist for a reason, she reminds herself. For moments like this, when she feels her heat building, as she imagines Catra under her, writhing a bit as she lets Adora work her over the edge. t is not like it *matters* what she justifies –nothing like this would ever happen between them, anyway.

h her mind, Catra comes at the same time she does. She forces herself to push down the instinct that says *wrong, wrong, wrong*.

The problem is, once she dismisses that one, a new one pops up, and this one she cannot fight with all the logic she has learned about kinks and preferences.

She does not want you.

--

All day thinking about Catra, planning around her moves –and she was not even there, leaving the fort to *Scorpia*. Worse yet, Adora cannot *do* anything about it, not in these temporary qarters in the fort with no guarantee of privacy. She lays in her cot that night, fists clenching in frustration as she tries to force her body to relax.

t does not work. The thoughts still come, Catra splayed out beneath her, or draped across her chest, or leaned back against a wall. Adora's hands on her, roaming and feeling as that content, post-orgasm purr Adora has only ever heard once rolls through her. Adora wants her –she wants her back, she wants her to just *listen* to her, she wants what she never had.

She never would have it. Adora tenses her muscles and forces her body still against its own desires. This is not what Adora – what *She-ra* - is for. She should be planning their next attack, not fantasizing about a captain of the enemy forces.

Enemy lines have never meant shit when it came to Catra, anyway.

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Adora will never be done thinking about that suit, not really. She will go to her deathbed with that suit still on her mind. Catra had been so confident in it – so in control. *Dominant*. A word Adora knows now, and she wants to apply it to herself, but it often fits Catra as well, even in the fantasies where she is coming apart beneath Adora. There are other words that fit Adora better, anyway. She can be on *top* without being the only one in control. That is her desire usually, but – not this time.

Catra is in control, cocky and smug like she had been as she dipped Adora at the ball. Adora's dress is long gone. They are not even in the ice palace, this time. No, Catra is in her room in Bright Moon, in that suit, kneeling over her. Her hands are sure, deft against Adora. She purrs to her, assurances and promises, making her shake beneath her hands.

It feels different than the other times she has thought about similar scenarios. This is Catra caring for her, in charge and reveling in it as Adora lets her have what she wants. Maybe that is what does it for her this time – the idea that she could be what Catra wants.

--

Adora's skin is healed – it always is – but she can still feel the familiar ache of Catra's claws on her. Normally, the lingering ache of She-ra's healing makes her clench her fists as she forces herself to grin and bear it. She has gotten good at powering through pain, ignoring it completely.

Maybe too good at it, if her current reaction is anything to go by. She lays down in her bed and swears she can feel the trails of Catra's claws on her skin still as she flexes the muscles underneath. She hates how it sends a thrill of excitement through her.

Unfortunately, she also understands it. She can never know how long she cared for Catra, not when she buried it so deep inside, but it was there for years. Add on her burgeoning attraction to her when they were just cadets, and Adora was thoroughly fucked as far as developing kinks that were *not* Catra-based goes. The logic, the knowledge behind it from some of her *extended research*, is the only thing that lets her swallow down the lump in her throat and finally touch herself.

Catra's head is between her legs, this time. Not something she thinks about often, simply because she does not actually *know* what it feels like. Touching Catra, Catra touching her – that sensation she can mimic herself, but this she can only imagine. Unfortunately, it is made easier because she *does* know what Catra's tongue feels like - on a wound on her arm, on her cheek once to be annoying, on her hand when Catra would lick it to get Adora to uncover her mouth after shushing her. Catra's tongue is *unique*, like the rest of her. Rough, not quite human. Imagining *that* between her legs has Adora covering her mouth with her free hand to stifle a whimper.

Catra's hands are on her thighs, claws out, slowly and carefully dragging *down*. She leaves raised white-and-pink lines on Adora's skin as she works her tongue over her. Adora's thighs clench at the image, and in the fantasy they squeeze down on Catra's head too roughly. Catra turns her head to the side, biting harshly at Adora's

inner thigh as a reminder. Adora's entire body arches up at the thought of Catra's *fangs*, rough but careful against her skin as her claws sweep down again.

t takes almost no time, not with the ghosts of Catra' s claws still on her skin. Adora comes back to herself gasping and can only desperately hope she was not too loud.

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At the time, Adora had been focused. Now, back in her room in Bright Moon, despite *everything after*, she is distracted. The thoughts twitch at her hands, and she has to abandon the battle schematics she is trying to plan out. She feels out of control, and she *hates* it. She hates that Catra can so easily reach inside of her and pull her apart. She should not do this – not now – but she cannot very well sit idle just because her hands are shaking. Best to just take care of it and return to work, no matter how shameful the interlude.

She stretches out on her bed, the ghost of ropes around her wrists already conjuring the scene. The *memory*, kneeling on the floor of Mara's old ship, Catra standing over her. Dominant, in control, *beautiful*. t had not made her feel like this at the time, but in her mind, now, it washes over her and she forces it to feel safe. Catra crouches before her to get down on her level, trailing her hands over Adora's body. Adora is bound just like she had been then. She has seen diagrams of moments like this in her research. Illustrations on how to tie ropes to restrict without pain – to restrict while bringing pleasure. At the time, her face had flushed just looking at the image – now she understands her reaction, more.

Catra's touch is exploratory, and Adora lets her own hands ghost over the path that Imaginary Catra takes. Eventually , Adora cannot keep her hands off herself any longer, and so Catra presses close to

her and purrs in her ear as she finally touches her, an odd mix between taunts and praise making Adora sqirm beneath her .

This fantasy is about control. t is safe to indulge in, now , alone in her room –but she still flinches inwardly at the thought of how much she is willing to give up, give away, despite everything that has happened between them. She should be stronger than this, should let these desires go, but-

She loves Catra. She tries to summon up the bitter feeling of self-hatred that usually comes at that thought, but it just will not come this time. She is tired, tired of fighting Catra, tired of this new fight she can see stirring with Glimmer, just tired. For a few moments, she indulges in a fantasy of giving up control, giving up power, and letting Catra care for her. Letting Catra love her.

She doesnt, but it is a nice few moments all the same.

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The new outfit would be the death of her. t did not have the same effect as the suit had, not nearly, but Catra is in it all the *time* now. At least the suit had been a onetime thing –at least the suit had *covered* her. Those slits on her legs –not new , not really, but they were purposeful now rather than the accidental tear Catra had mirrored on her other leg when they were teenagers. The *window*, making it so easy for Adora to imagine placing her hand on her chest, stroking the exposed patch, feeling Catra's long-gone purr rumble beneath her touch.

Then there was the way the entire thing molded to her body as she stood there, hand on her hip, cocky and sure. Somehow despite her shorter stature compared to Adora –even compared to *She-ra* – Catra always manages to make Adora feel like she is looking down

at her, these days. She has changed her hair, too, the image of confidence and control.

Adora still remembers the kitten who did not know how to retract her claws or why she *should*. She remembers the girl she had comforted in the dead of night after a reprimanding from Shadow Weaver. She remembers the girl who had comforted her back when Adora was the one who disappointed their superior officer. Catra can wear this skin all she likes – Adora knows who is under it.

She has held off for a while now. Her nightmares – her golden dreams – are getting more frequent, now . She just needs a moment of indulgence, of release, and then she can go back to – whatever she had been doing before she found herself unable to think of anything but Catra. Catra is still on her mind, so she cannot remember it, yet.

She lays down in her bed as she pictures Catra, in that new outfit, but in their old bunk. The two of them close together, after-hours, in a bed not meant to take the adults they are now. Pressed close together as Adora slides that mask off her face, letting it just be *them*, none of the violent pretense of the last few years. She pushes Catra's shoulder down until she lies back. She lets Adora straddle her and then slowly, carefully, peel her out of that skintight suit, running her hands along her as she does so. Adora presses kisses down the length of her body as she goes. Catra hisses at her to *hurry up*, but she does not always get to have what she wants. Adora returns the hand that had been on her shoulder, holding her still while she finishes stripping her.

The mere sight of Catra laid bare, returned – more-or-less – to how Adora remembers Catra looking when she last trusted her should not do as much for Adora as it does. It does not matter what it should do, though – Adora is already almost there, just imagining her ex-best-friend beneath her like this. It is her very first fantasy , Adora realizes, Catra laid out beneath her in the Fright Zone. This time, she feels no shame at what she wants – she hardly feels any shame at *who* she wants, at this point. She has long come to terms with that.

She is ashamed of *want*, in general. She is not meant to have these desires, these emotions. Attachments like this are what dragged Mara down, caused her to fail. f Adora wants to avoid repeating her mistakes, she has to let Catra go.

She has to stop to laugh out loud at that, bitter and cruel. A bit like the only laughs she gets to hear from Catra anymore. f the portal was not going to put an end to this, nothing would. Nothing would ever give her the strength to let Catra go. Not even Catra, in all her shadowy scheming, can drive Adora from her. Adora hopes that is just what love is like, rather than an utter failing on her part.

--

She sneaks away from the rebel camp, one night. She has not done this since abandoning the safety of Bright Moon, but-

Without She-ra, she feels so useless, so out of control. She just needs to do something to get it back, if just for a moment. She tells Swift Wind she is going for a walk to try and tire herself out for bed. Accounting for someone panicking if they found her missing takes the last vestiges of her presence of mind. She practically runs from the camp. She does not stop until the clearing is well out-of-sight.

She knows the Whispering Woods, in a way she does not really understand. She-ra is connected to them, somehow - or maybe just magic in general is, through the heart. She wanders her way through the forest, knowing it will lead her wherever she needs to be.

She ends up at a half-ruined hut, clearly a victim of one of the Horde's rampages through the area. t still has four walls, even if the roof is long-gone. When she wanders inside, she finds it empty of anything but rubble, either abandoned before its destruction or later

salvaged. She settles in a corner and tries – tries to just focus on *control*.

She knew what she was going to do as soon as she left the camp. Her ruse of focusing on control lasts all of three seconds. The image springs to her mind, unbidden, of Catra, laid out beneath her in the bed she misses from Bright Moon. Catra has her hands above her head, clasping them together under Adora's instruction. She leaves them there even as Adora travels down her body, even as she uses one hand on her hip to keep her still as she drops her mouth to Catra's chest, the subject of so many of her dirty teenage thoughts before she understood their real source or meaning.

Adora's hand finally slips in her waistband as the scene begins to play out. Catra gasps, sighs, huffs as Adora explores her, holds her in place with her hand and command. Adora has not seen or heard word from Catra since Horde Prime landed – but she has not heard word from *any* of the Etherian Horde, really. She is worried – about a lot, but about the subject of this specific fantasy, as well. It would deter her if she were not wound so tight.

All this time, trying to let go, trying to do what Light Hope told her, and for what? To set off a doomsday weapon, to lose Glimmer, to lose the only *place* that has felt like home, for Catra to fall off the face of Etheria? It feels like all she has ever done is follow orders, and all that could go wrong has.

Not tonight. Tonight, she sneaks away to rebel. Tonight, she imagines Catra pinned beneath her, mouth on her chest, free hand running along her body to meet her, *take* her. She thrusts into her, drinks down the whines that she produces as she lets Adora rock her. She struggles her hips a bit, trying to get *more*, but Adora does not give it to her. She can have it when Adora decides she has had her fill of watching the girl she lo-

The girl she *grew up with*, writhing in pleasure beneath her. It does not take long, after such a gap, after such tension, for Adora to spill over. She lays there, in the dusty ruin, panting and gasping. For

maybe the first time in a long time, she feels no shame, despite what she has just pictured. Now she does not have ancient alien protocols telling her to *let go*, apparently wanting Catra is finally something she can just take pleasure in, even if she will never have it, could never have it.

As she stands from the ground, dusting herself off as she fixes her clothes, she wonders where Catra is hiding out, right now. She is not in the Fright Zone, now , certainly. Their old spot is long abandoned.

As easily as they led her in, the Woods lead her back out to the clearing. Adora makes sure Swift Wind sees her for a moment before she ducks into her tent to finally lay down. She feels better, a bit. She still feels useless, still feels like a burden, but- she is at least accepting of her thoughts on Catra.

She still doesn't love you.

Yeah, she knows. But with the world falling down on top of her, and with the other girl nowhere in sight to prove her otherwise - it feels nice, to pretend.

End Notes

Okay despite my denial on being a smut writer – this fic is my soapbox and I'm standing on it. I know the fandom is split on how they portray Adora's awareness of sex, but I find the idea that the Horde would not have sex ed completely ludicrous as someone who has taught it before. In such a tense environment there is no way there are not hookups going on no matter how tight the fist is, and teaching nothing is begging for disease. Especially with multiple species running around complicating things. This fic is basically me world-building smut fantasies around that concept. Also the fact there is no way that Adora "Built An Obstacle Course For A Ball" Greyskull did not do research once she was free to.

If you're interested I explore the Horde's stance on sex a bit more in jealous sea (comes like waves & can't breathe).

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!